The classification of the houses as angular, succedent, and cadent has survived intact into modern practice. The *angular* houses are identified as the first, tenth, fourth, and seventh and are considered to be strong; the *succedent* houses, the second, fifth, eighth, and eleventh are said to be moderate in strength; the *cadent* houses, the third, sixth, ninth, and twelfth are thought to be weak. Nechepso the King and Serapio said that angular and succedent houses are most conducive to business.[7] In this context, *chrēmatistikos* is understood as a place that provides the strength and dynamic energy that enables a planet to act effectively and profitably. When referring to a planet's relative angularity, *chrēmatistikos* has been translated in the astrological texts as "profitable, conducive to business, advantageous, effective, operative, busy, strong, energetic, and dynamic". Its opposite, *achrēmatistikos*, is variously translated as "unprofitable, non-conducive to business, disadvantageous, ineffective, inoperative, slack, weak, and unenergetic".

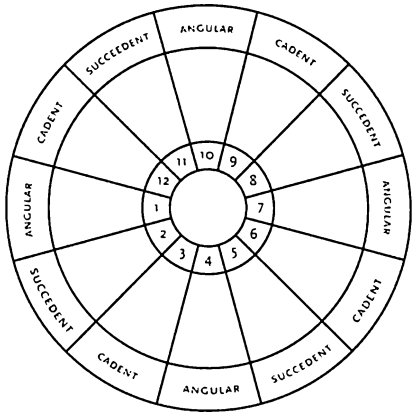


FIGURE 98. ANGULARITY OF THE HOUSES

The first, tenth, seventh, and fourth houses are angular and considered strong. The second, eleventh, eighth, and fifth houses are succedent and considered of moderate strength. The third, twelfth, ninth, and sixth houses are cadent and considered weak.

7 NECHEPSO as quoted by ANTIOCHUS, *Summary* 19; SERAPIO, *Definitions*, CCAG 8.4.225–232.

for the first eight houses, following a tradition based on an eight-house system (*oktotopos*). For Sahl ibn Bishr, we have consulted the Arabic and Latin versions of his text, and condensed the significations from both to avoid repetition.[2] The entries for al-Qabīsī include the material that he attributes to Alendezgod, as well as significations attributed to Alcabitius given in Ibn Ezra's *The Beginning of Wisdom*. Guido Bonatti's significations largely repeat the Arabic sources that preceded him. His entries have been pruned to reflect his own contributions (where he has provided them), as well as the significations that he draws from sources that we do not have separate entries for.[3]

Among the modern astrologers, we have referred mostly to astrological texts from the twentieth century (1898–1985). The books used to assemble the lists for this period were restricted to those with dedicated sections on the significations of each house. Alan Leo's entries synthesize significations from two different books published in the same decade (1904, 1910). However, we have retained two entries for Dane Rudhyar, whose two cited works were published almost forty years apart, in order to better display his influence on the intervening astrologers. First editions of modern works have been followed whenever possible.[4]

The significations listed in the house tables that follow are drawn more or less verbatim, with occasional modifications, from the cited sources. As a result, the descriptions retain the style, character, and expression of the individual authors. While some rough edges have been smoothed out, a certain degree of unevenness remains, especially with regards to flow and expression, reflecting the stylistic diversity of the sources over time.

2 Principally via Benjamin N. Dyke's translations. See the annotated bibliography at the end of this volume for details.

3 The Arabic astrologers that Bonatti quotes on the significations of the houses include: ad-Dawla, al-Andarzagar, al-Qabīsī, Sahl ibn Bishr, al-Mansur, al-Khaiyāt, al-Qalandar, al-Battani, 'Umar al-Tabari, Albuaz, and al-Kindi.

4 Max and Augusta Heindel's *Message of the Stars* (1913) was consulted in its 1927 edition, which follows the 1922 revised version.

a summary of the procedures advocated by other astrologers, which sometimes indicate a different planet or point as Predominator.

THE PREDOMINATOR ACCORDING TO ANTIOCHUS AND PORPHYRY

The optimal choice for the Predominator is a light that is angular, in the east, and of the sect of the chart. These conditions predispose the luminary to best represent the source of the life force, with the further authority to designate one of its lords as *Oikodespotēs*, which can then allot the years of life in accordance with its own condition. However, if the light of the sect is cadent, the predomination might go to the other light if it satisfies certain requirements. If both the Sun and Moon are too weak by virtue of being cadent or in the west, the responsibility would go to the Ascendant to provide one of its lords as the ultimate ruler of life. Before we examine this procedure in more detail, let us first look at the issue of the house system.

HOUSE SYSTEM

The Porphyry text that we are following does not specify any particular house system, so we may assume that he used whole signs for determining the Predominator. Dorotheus also seems to have used the whole-sign house system. There are differing views as to whether Valens used the Porphyry house system for the entirety of this particular inquiry, or whether he used whole-sign houses for identifying the Predominator and limited the use of the Porphyry house system to assess the strength of an *Oikodespotēs* relative to its dynamic angularity in "profitable degrees" that could span both an angular and succedent sign. Ptolemy employed his own version of equal houses. Given the complexity of this doctrine and the introductory scope of this book, I am going to keep my initial explanation as simple as possible. Thus, because Porphyry does not mention a switch to any other house system for this procedure, we will remain with the whole-sign house system.[2]

It is nevertheless important to be aware of the variants, which you may encounter in your readings. If you are going to experiment with the approaches of other astrologers, I suggest that you use the house system that each astrologer

2 Remember that the text written by Porphyry and the originator of the Porphyry house system are not the same person. Be careful not to confuse the two.